

I LOST MY NETWORK INTERFACES AFTER REBOOTING MY UBUNTU SERVER!!



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While practicing Linux Networking Administration, I use Ubuntu Desktop as a DHCP relay for my lab setup.

Everything was working perfectly — until I rebooted my machine. 😊

THE PROBLEM

After reboot, I noticed that the network icon disappeared.



I opened the terminal and typed:

ifconfig

```
hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ ifconfig
lo: flags=73<UP,LOOPBACK,RUNNING>  mtu 65536
    inet 127.0.0.1  netmask 255.0.0.0
    inet6 ::1  prefixlen 128  scopeid 0x10<host>
    loop txqueuelen 1000  (Local Loopback)
    RX packets 1209  bytes 91195 (91.1 KB)
    RX errors 0  dropped 0  overruns 0  frame 0
    TX packets 1209  bytes 91195 (91.1 KB)
    TX errors 0  dropped 0 overruns 0  carrier 0  collisions 0

hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$
```

Only the lo (loopback) interface appeared!

So I checked with:

`ip a`

```
hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ ip a
1: lo: <LOOPBACK,UP,LOWER_UP> mtu 65536 qdisc noqueue state UNKNOWN group default qlen 1000
    link/loopback 00:00:00:00:00:00 brd 00:00:00:00:00:00
    inet 127.0.0.1/8 scope host lo
        valid_lft forever preferred_lft forever
    inet6 ::1/128 scope host
        valid_lft forever preferred_lft forever
2: ens33: <BROADCAST,MULTICAST> mtu 1500 qdisc fq_codel state DOWN group default qlen 1000
    link/ether 00:0c:29:1a:eb:0f brd ff:ff:ff:ff:ff:ff
    altname enp2s1
3: ens37: <BROADCAST,MULTICAST> mtu 1500 qdisc fq_codel state DOWN group default qlen 1000
    link/ether 00:0c:29:1a:eb:19 brd ff:ff:ff:ff:ff:ff
    altname enp2s5
hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$
```

This time, both of my interfaces were there — but DOWN.

Okay, fine — maybe I just need to bring them up manually:

`sudo ip link set ens33 up`

`sudo ip link set ens37 up`

Interfaces are up now... but no IP addresses assigned. 😊

```
hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ sudo ip link set ens33 up
hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ sudo ip link set ens37 up
hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ ifconfig
ens33: flags=4163<UP,BROADCAST,RUNNING,MULTICAST> mtu 1500
    inet6 fe80::20c:29ff:fe1a:eb0f prefixlen 64 scopeid 0x20<link>
    ether 00:0c:29:1a:eb:0f txqueuelen 1000 (Ethernet)
    RX packets 0 bytes 0 (0.0 B)
    RX errors 0 dropped 0 overruns 0 frame 0
    TX packets 118 bytes 13097 (13.0 KB)
    TX errors 0 dropped 0 overruns 0 carrier 0 collisions 0

ens37: flags=4163<UP,BROADCAST,RUNNING,MULTICAST> mtu 1500
    inet6 fe80::20c:29ff:fe1a:eb19 prefixlen 64 scopeid 0x20<link>
    ether 00:0c:29:1a:eb:19 txqueuelen 1000 (Ethernet)
    RX packets 0 bytes 0 (0.0 B)
```

STEP-BY-STEP TROUBLESHOOTING

Checked Netplan Configuration

```
GNU nano 6.2 /etc/netplan/01-network-manager-all.yaml
# Let NetworkManager manage all devices on this system
network:
  version: 2
  renderer: NetworkManager
  ethernets:
    ens33:
      dhcp4: false
      addresses:
        - 192.168.0.3/24
      routes:
        - to: default
          via: 192.168.0.1
    ens37:
      dhcp4: false
      addresses:
        - 192.168.100.1/24
```

Everything looked good — my static IPs were correctly defined.

I ran:

```
sudo netplan apply
```

→ No change.

```
rosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$
rosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ sudo netplan apply
rosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ ifconfig
ens33: flags=4163<UP,BROADCAST,RUNNING,MULTICAST> mtu 1500
    ether 00:0c:29:1a:eb:0f txqueuelen 1000 (Ethernet)
    RX packets 0 bytes 0 (0.0 B)
    RX errors 0 dropped 0 overruns 0 frame 0
    TX packets 127 bytes 13955 (13.9 KB)
    TX errors 0 dropped 0 overruns 0 carrier 0 collisions 0

ens37: flags=4163<UP,BROADCAST,RUNNING,MULTICAST> mtu 1500
    ether 00:0c:29:1a:eb:19 txqueuelen 1000 (Ethernet)
    RX packets 0 bytes 0 (0.0 B)
    RX errors 0 dropped 0 overruns 0 frame 0
    TX packets 100 bytes 12347 (12.3 KB)
    TX errors 0 dropped 0 overruns 0 carrier 0 collisions 0

lo: flags=73<UP,LOOPBACK,RUNNING> mtu 65536
```

Checked NetworkManager Service

`systemctl status NetworkManager`

→ Active and running.

```
hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ systemctl status NetworkManager
● NetworkManager.service - Network Manager
   Loaded: loaded (/lib/systemd/system/NetworkManager.service; enabled; vendor preset: e
   Active: active (running) since Fri 2025-10-24 02:51:03 EDT; 2min 2s ago
     Docs: man:NetworkManager(8)
   Main PID: 2277 (NetworkManager)
    Tasks: 3 (limit: 2209)
   Memory: 3.0M
      CPU: 92ms
   CGroup: /system.slice/NetworkManager.service
           └─2277 /usr/sbin/NetworkManager --no-daemon

Oct 24 02:51:03 SERVER-BE NetworkManager[2277]: <info> [1761288663.4942] device (lo): car
Oct 24 02:51:03 SERVER-BE NetworkManager[2277]: <info> [1761288663.4955] manager: (lo): n
Oct 24 02:51:03 SERVER-BE NetworkManager[2277]: <info> [1761288663.5054] device (ens33):
Oct 24 02:51:03 SERVER-BE NetworkManager[2277]: <info> [1761288663.5070] manager: (ens33)
Oct 24 02:51:03 SERVER-BE NetworkManager[2277]: <info> [1761288663.5165] device (ens37):
Oct 24 02:51:03 SERVER-BE NetworkManager[2277]: <info> [1761288663.5181] manager: (ens37)
```

Checked systemd-networkd

`systemctl status systemd-networkd`

→ Also running fine.

```
hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ systemctl status systemd-networkd
● systemd-networkd.service - Network Configuration
   Loaded: loaded (/lib/systemd/system/systemd-networkd.service; disabled; vendor preset
   Active: active (running) since Fri 2025-10-24 02:53:57 EDT; 2s ago
 TriggeredBy: ● systemd-networkd.socket
     Docs: man:systemd-networkd.service(8)
   Main PID: 2328 (systemd-network)
    Status: "Processing requests..."
    Tasks: 1 (limit: 2209)
   Memory: 2.8M
      CPU: 105ms
   CGroup: /system.slice/systemd-networkd.service
           └─2328 /lib/systemd/systemd-networkd

Oct 24 02:53:57 SERVER-BE systemd[1]: Starting Network Configuration...
Oct 24 02:53:57 SERVER-BE systemd-networkd[2328]: ens37: Link UP
Oct 24 02:53:57 SERVER-BE systemd-networkd[2328]: ens37: Gained carrier
Oct 24 02:53:57 SERVER-BE systemd-networkd[2328]: ens33: Link UP
```

Looked for logs

```
journalctl -xe | grep network
```

```
7 SERVER-BE systemd-networkd[2328]: ens37: Link UP  
7 SERVER-BE systemd-networkd[2328]: ens37: Gained carrier  
7 SERVER-BE systemd-networkd[2328]: ens33: Link UP  
7 SERVER-BE systemd-networkd[2328]: ens33: Gained carrier  
7 SERVER-BE systemd-networkd[2328]: lo: Link UP  
7 SERVER-BE systemd-networkd[2328]: lo: Gained carrier  
7 SERVER-BE systemd-networkd[2328]: Enumeration completed
```

→ No relevant errors.

Meanwhile, the network icon was still missing, and when I rechecked ip a — the interfaces were down again. 🙄

THE REALIZATION

After a while of spinning in circles... I suddenly realized something: I never checked nmcli — the NetworkManager command-line utility. 😊

So I ran:

```
sudo nmcli networking on
```

And just like that — everything came back to life! ☑

My interfaces were up, IPs assigned, and the network icon reappeared.

```
hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ sudo nmcli networking on
hosniadmin@SERVER-BE:~/Desktop$ ifconfig
ens33: flags=4163<UP,BROADCAST,RUNNING,MULTICAST> mtu 1500
    inet 192.168.0.3 netmask 255.255.255.0 broadcast 192.168.0.255
    inet6 fe80::20c:29ff:fe1a:eb0f prefixlen 64 scopeid 0x20<link>
    ether 00:0c:29:1a:eb:0f txqueuelen 1000 (Ethernet)
    RX packets 0 bytes 0 (0.0 B)
    RX errors 0 dropped 0 overruns 0 frame 0
    TX packets 172 bytes 19214 (19.2 KB)
    TX errors 0 dropped 0 overruns 0 carrier 0 collisions 0

ens37: flags=4163<UP,BROADCAST,RUNNING,MULTICAST> mtu 1500
    inet 192.168.100.1 netmask 255.255.255.0 broadcast 192.168.100.255
    inet6 fe80::20c:29ff:fe1a:eb19 prefixlen 64 scopeid 0x20<link>
    ether 00:0c:29:1a:eb:19 txqueuelen 1000 (Ethernet)
    RX packets 0 bytes 0 (0.0 B)
    RX errors 0 dropped 0 overruns 0 frame 0
    TX packets 140 bytes 17343 (17.3 KB)
    TX errors 0 dropped 0 overruns 0 carrier 0 collisions 0

lo: flags=73<UP,LOOPBACK,RUNNING> mtu 65536
    inet 127.0.0.1 netmask 255.0.0.0
```

THE ROOT CAUSE

It turns out that after the reboot, NetworkManager networking was disabled, even though the service itself was active.

So all my manual attempts with Netplan and systemd had no effect — because NetworkManager was simply not managing any connections.

LESSON LEARNED

Sometimes, the issue isn't in the configuration file, nor the services, nor the routes...

It's just a missing tool in the troubleshooting chain.